

COLLECTION · INVESTORS

Short-Term Rentals and Airbnb

What is legal in Quebec before you get into short-term rentals

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It offers general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. As every real estate situation is different, it is recommended that you consult the appropriate professionals before making any decision regarding a real estate transaction.

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Short-Term Rentals and Airbnb

What is legal in Quebec before you get into short-term rentals

Short-term rentals (Airbnb-style) are appealing for their potential income, but they are heavily regulated in Quebec — and the rules are tightening. Before buying or converting a unit, you must understand the legal framework, on pain of fines and blockages.

This guide takes stock of the required authorizations, municipal zoning, co-ownership rules and taxation — without ever assuming that “it’ll be fine”.

2026 edition note: the regulation changes fast; always confirm the rules in force at the time of your project. Informational content, not legal advice. Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page.

Short-term rentals are appealing for their income, but they're heavily regulated and full of traps. This guide covers the provincial framework, municipal zoning (often decisive), co-ownership rules, real profitability and good operating practices.

The through-line: check that you're allowed to operate BEFORE dreaming about the income.

CHAPTER

The provincial framework: registration and posting

Understanding the basic obligations.

In Quebec, offering short-term tourist accommodation is regulated: it generally requires registration and the posting of a number on the listings, as well as compliance with safety rules and tourist taxation. Platforms and authorities have stepped up enforcement.

Renting without the required authorizations exposes you to significant fines. “I’ll do it quietly” is not a viable strategy.

In Quebec, short-term tourist accommodation is regulated: registration, a number to post, and tax obligations. Operating without complying exposes you to significant fines. The first step isn't to decorate the listing, but to check that you're allowed to operate, and how.

EMILIE'S TIP

Don't rely on stories of people who “rent without doing anything”. Enforcement has tightened and the fines are heavy. Start from the principle that you have to be compliant, period.

CHAPTER

Municipal zoning: the decisive factor

Checking whether short-term is even allowed at the address.

Beyond the provincial rules, each municipality (and borough) sets its zoning: short-term rental is only allowed in certain zones, sometimes only for a principal residence, often forbidden elsewhere. This is THE factor that determines whether your project is possible.

- Check the precise zoning of the target address BEFORE buying.
- Distinguish principal residence vs dedicated dwelling (the rules differ).
- Some cities heavily limit or prohibit short-term.

Municipal zoning is the decisive factor: beyond the provincial rules, each city (and often each area) allows or prohibits short-term. An address can be perfect on paper and totally off-limits to short-term. Check the zoning BEFORE buying while counting on Airbnb.

EMILIE'S TIP

Check the zoning of the EXACT address before buying for an Airbnb. A perfectly profitable project on paper is worth zero if short-term is forbidden at that address.

CHAPTER

Co-ownership and building bylaws

Not forgetting the “co-ownership” layer.

In a condo, even if the city and the province allowed it, the declaration of co-ownership can prohibit or limit short-term rental. Many co-ownerships explicitly prohibit it to preserve the building's quiet and insurance.

So check three layers: provincial, municipal (zoning) AND co-ownership. A single prohibition is enough to block the project.

In co-ownership, a layer is added: even if the city and the province allow it, the declaration of co-ownership can prohibit short-term rental. Many buildings ban it. Read the declaration and the bylaws — ignoring them exposes you to lawsuits from the syndicate.

EMILIE'S TIP

Short-term must be allowed at ALL THREE levels: province, city and co-ownership. A single prohibition is enough to block everything — check all three before committing.

CHAPTER

Real profitability and risks

Assessing short-term as a real business.

- Variable income (seasonality, occupancy rate) vs high costs (cleaning, management, furniture, wear).
- Intensive management: it's a job, not passive income.
- Regulatory risk: the rules can change and reduce, or even prohibit, the activity.
- Compare honestly with what a classic long-term rental would bring.

Short-term can be profitable, but it's more demanding and riskier than it looks. Enter it with your eyes open.

Assess short-term as a real business: variable income (seasonality, occupancy rate) vs high costs (cleaning, management, furniture, platforms, specific insurance). The advertised profitability melts fast if you neglect these costs and the active management this model requires.

EMILIE'S TIP

Always compare short-term with a good long-term rental, taking into account the work and the regulatory risk. Often, long-term offers a better peace-of-mind/return ratio.

CHAPTER

Operating well: taxation, insurance, management

Operating without nasty surprises.

Once short-term rental is authorized, you still have to **operate it correctly**:

- **Taxation:** the income is taxable and certain taxes may apply.
- **Insurance:** a policy suited to short-term rental (a classic home policy may not cover it).
- **Management:** check-in, cleaning, maintenance, review management.
- **Neighbourhood:** noise and respect for the rules to avoid complaints.

The advertised profitability melts fast if you neglect these very real costs and obligations.

Once authorized, operate correctly: taxation (taxable income, applicable taxes), insurance suited to short-term (a classic home policy often doesn't cover it), management (check-in, cleaning, reviews) and respect for the neighbourhood. An uncovered claim can wipe out years of income.

EMILIE'S TIP

Check that your insurance really covers short-term rental: many home policies don't. An uncovered claim can wipe out years of income in one go.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Check the zoning of the address and the municipal rules.
2. Check the declaration of co-ownership where applicable.

Within 30 days

1. Confirm the registration and tax obligations.
2. Honestly compare short-term vs long-term.

Next

1. Only go ahead if all three levels allow it and the numbers hold up.

Before I start

1. Check municipal zoning, provincial rules and, in a condo, the declaration.
2. Build a realistic budget and take out insurance suited to short-term.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Registration: the authorization required for short-term tourist accommodation.
 - Zoning: municipal rules determining where short-term is allowed.
 - Principal residence vs dedicated dwelling: often different regimes.
 - Declaration of co-ownership: can prohibit short-term in a condo.
 - Regulatory risk: changing rules that may limit the activity.
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- Registration: mandatory registration and number for tourist accommodation.
 - Zoning: the municipal rule determining whether short-term is allowed at the address.
 - Declaration of co-ownership: can prohibit short-term rental in a condo.
 - Occupancy rate: the proportion of nights rented, key to profitability.
 - Short-term insurance: specific coverage, distinct from classic home insurance.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. Short-term rental in Quebec is:

- A) Free everywhere
- B) Heavily regulated (registration, posting, taxation)
- C) Forbidden everywhere
- D) Without rules

2. The decisive feasibility factor is often:

- A) The colour
- B) The municipal zoning of the address
- C) The price
- D) The neighbour

3. In a condo, short-term can be:

- A) Always allowed
- B) Prohibited by the declaration of co-ownership
- C) Mandatory
- D) Without rules

4. How many levels must allow short-term?

- A) Only one
- B) Three (province, city, co-ownership)
- C) None
- D) Five

5. Renting without authorization exposes you to:

- A) Nothing
- B) Significant fines
- C) A bonus
- D) A gift

6. Short-term is:

- A) 100% passive income
- B) Intensive management, like a business
- C) Without costs
- D) Without risk

7. Regulatory risk means:

- A) No change
- B) The rules can change and limit the activity
- C) A guarantee
- D) Nothing

8. Before buying for short-term, you must:

- A) Rely on rumours
- B) Check the exact zoning of the address
- C) Ignore the city
- D) Improvise

Answer key

- 1. **B** — A strict provincial framework (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — Zoning determines whether it's allowed (ch. 2).
- 3. **B** — Co-ownership is a 3rd layer (ch. 3).
- 4. **B** — One prohibition is enough to block it (ch. 3).
- 5. **B** — Enforcement has tightened (ch. 1).
- 6. **B** — Cleaning, management, wear (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — To factor into the decision (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — The exact address is decisive (ch. 2).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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